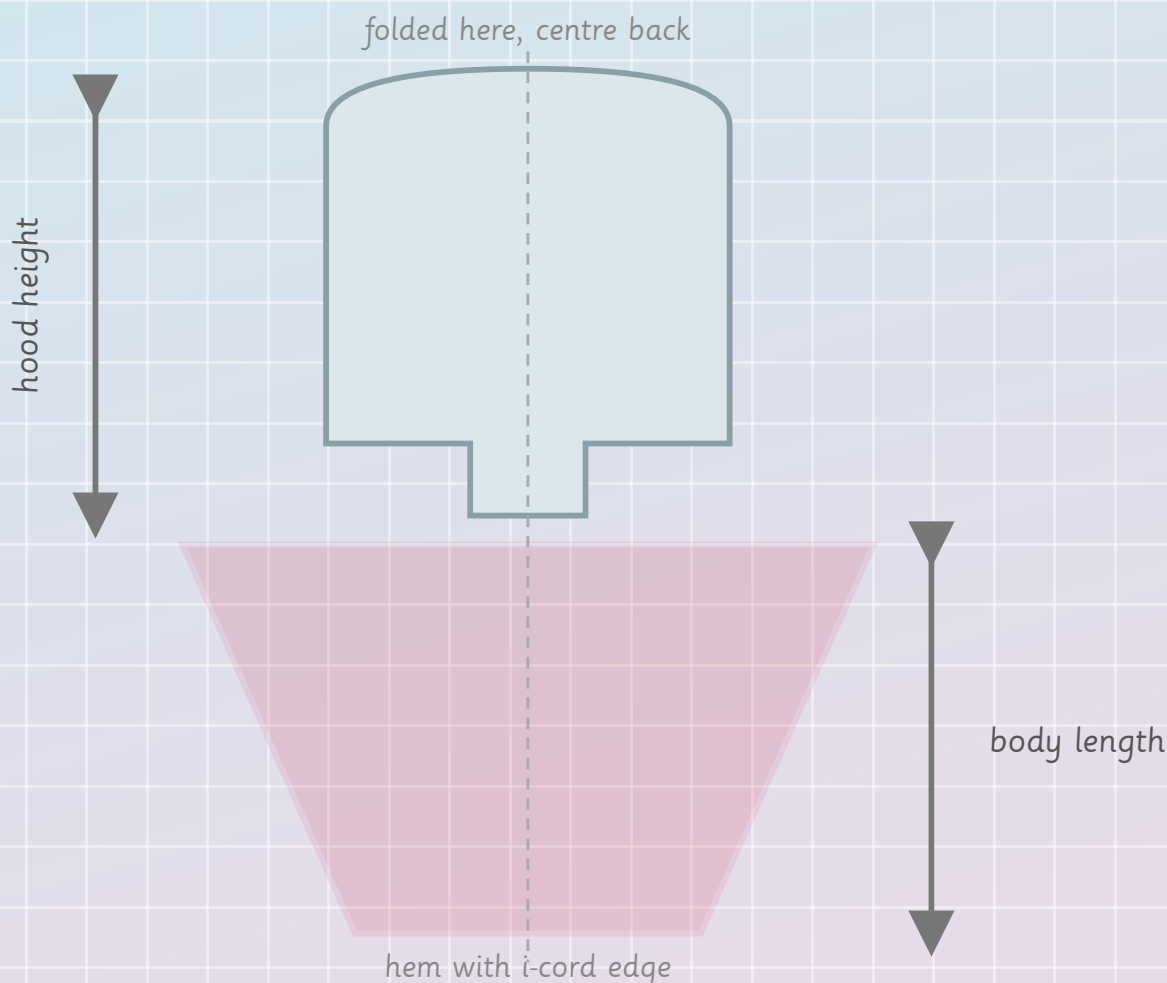




LME KNITTING PATTERN

LME MINI & ME PONCHO FOR BABY, WITH HOOD

SIZE B1-B3

An easy-knit poncho with a hood, knitted in one piece from the top down. The hood is knitted flat first and seamed with one simple seam, then the stitches are picked up and the rest of the poncho is knitted exactly like the kids' and adult versions: in the round, with eight even increase lines, a continuous i-cord edge and one fastening on each side. No splits and no extra seaming of the body itself.



By Renate Dahl

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Little Montessori Explorers

BEFORE YOU START

The poncho is knitted flat from the top of the hood, seamed with one seam, and then continues in the round to the hem. Eight even increase lines shape the round silhouette. After the last increase, all stitches are knitted plain in the round with no further shaping. The buttonholes are made on the back part of the same round piece, right above the hem. The buttons are sewn on the front part.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- to knit a simple hood flat and seam it
- to pick up stitches along an edge
- to knit in the round on a circular needle
- to increase evenly in eight sections
- to make a simple buttonhole
- to bind off with i-cord all round the hem

HOW HARD IS IT?

Easy to a little practised. You should be able to cast on, knit and purl, and knit in the round. Increases, buttonholes and i-cord bind-off are explained step by step. The hood seam and picking up stitches are also explained step by step.

One step at a time, and in the end you have a poncho.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Air (65% alpaca, 28% polyamide, 7% wool, 50 g = approx. 150 m). The poncho is knitted with one strand.

Size	Amount	Skeins
B1	150 g	3
B2	200 g	4
B3	250 g	5

NEEDLES AND KIT

- 4.5 mm circular needle, 40 cm, for the hood
- 5 mm circular needle, 60–100 cm, for the rest of the poncho
- 8 stitch markers and 4 removable markers
- 2 flat buttons, approx. 18–25 mm
- tapestry needle and tape measure

GAUGE

17 stitches and 22 rows in stockinette = 10 × 10 cm on 5 mm needles after washing and drying. Knit a swatch. Change needle size if your gauge does not match.

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

WHICH SIZE?

Choose first by age or usual size. The poncho has plenty of ease. Full length is measured from the top of the hood to the hem. Width is measured flat across the unbuttoned garment.

Code	Size	Head	Stitches	Width	Length	Arm opening
B1	0–6 mo	40 cm	136	ca. 40 cm	ca. 36 cm	ca. 13 cm
B2	6–12 mo	44 cm	160	ca. 47 cm	ca. 41 cm	ca. 15 cm
B3	12–24 mo	47 cm	176	ca. 52 cm	ca. 46 cm	ca. 17 cm

IMPORTANT ABOUT THE CONSTRUCTION

All sizes are knitted as one round piece. There is no side opening that is cut or knitted separately. The arm opening is only formed once a point on the front part is buttoned to a point on the back part on each side.

Try the poncho on as you go. The length can easily be adjusted before the buttonholes are knitted.

TECHNIQUES AND GLOSSARY

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
rnd	round
k / p	knit / purl
inc 1	lift the strand between stitches and knit it through the back loop
stockinette in the round	all stitches knitted plain
i-cord	narrow knitted cord edge

1 - THE HOOD

Cast on with the 4.5 mm circular needle (flat, not in the round):

Size	Cast on	Rib height
B1	64 m	2 cm
B2	72 m	2 cm
B3	80 m	2 cm

Knit *1 knit, 1 purl* back and forth until the rib has the given height, this becomes the edge around the face opening. Switch to the 5 mm needle and continue in stockinette back and forth (knit on right side rows, purl on wrong side rows) until the hood measures the total height from the cast-on:

Size	Total hood height
B1	16 cm
B2	18 cm
B3	20 cm

Bind off. Fold the hood in half so the side edges on each side meet, with the cast-on edge as the face opening and the bound-off edge at the bottom. Sew the two side edges together from the fold point (centre top) down to the bound-off edge. This becomes the seam at the centre back of the hood.

Straight needles work just as well as a circular needle while the hood is knitted flat, use what you have.

ROUND INCREASE SECTION

2 - PLACE THE MARKERS

- 1 With the right side facing out, pick up stitches with the 5 mm circular needle evenly along the bottom edge of the hood (the bound-off edge): the same number of stitches you cast on for the hood. Place a clear round marker at centre back, at the hood seam.

Divide the stitches into 8 equal sections with markers. The round marker is also the first increase marker.

Size	Stitches per section
B1	8
B2	9
B3	10

3 - INCREASE ROUND

Knit to the next marker, increase 1 stitch to the right, move the marker over.
Repeat at all 8 markers. This increases 8 stitches.

Then knit 1 whole round plain with no increases. Repeat these two rounds until the right stitch count is reached:

Size	Increase rounds	Stitches after increases	Approx. length
B1	9	136	ca. 12 cm
B2	11	160	ca. 15 cm
B3	12	176	ca. 17 cm

Checkpoint: The right stitch count matters most. If the height is off, keep knitting with no increases until the work has the given length.

KNIT ON IN THE ROUND

4 - THE WHOLE PONCHO

Remove the 7 ordinary increase markers, but keep the round marker at centre back. Knit all stitches plain in the round with no more increases. Continue until the work measures approx. 1.5 cm less than the given full length.

Size	Stop at
B1	34.5 cm
B2	39.5 cm
B3	44.5 cm

5 - SIDE FASTENING

Lay the work flat with the round marker at centre back. Find the middle of each side.

Count the given number of stitches from the side middle towards the front and place a marker for the button. Count the same number of stitches towards the back and place a marker for the buttonhole.

Size	Stitches
B1	11
B2	13
B3	14

The work is still one whole, unbroken circle. Nothing is split.

BUTTONHOLE AND I-CORD EDGE

PLACEMENT FROM CENTRE BACK

Point	Knapphull 1	Knapp 1	Knapp 2	Knapphull 2
B1	23	45	91	113
B2	27	53	107	133
B3	30	58	118	146

6 - BUTTONHOLE

Knit to the first buttonhole marker: yarn over, k2tog. Knit to the next buttonhole marker and repeat. Finish the round. Then knit 1 whole plain round, also across the yarn overs.

7 - I-CORD EDGE

Cast on 3 new stitches on the left needle. Knit 2. Knit the next i-cord stitch together with the next poncho stitch through the back loop. Slide the 3 stitches back without turning. Repeat all round the hem. Sew the beginning and end neatly together.

The i-cord edge runs continuously all round the poncho.

FINISHING

8 - THE BUTTONS

Sew one button on securely at each marker on the front part, right above the i-cord edge. Button each one through the buttonhole on the back part on the same side. The back part lies over the front part. Weave in ends, wash gently and dry flat.

FINISHING TOUCHES

- ☐ Weave in all ends on the wrong side.
- ☐ Soak the garment in lukewarm water with wool wash. Do not rub or wring.
- ☐ Press the water out in a towel and dry flat to the given measurements.
- ☐ Check the buttons after drying and sew them extra securely.

Before this pattern is sold: every size must be test-knitted, measured after washing and technically checked.

Happy knitting!



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